



FROST DATES & SEASON

Last frost: May 15 – June 1
First frost: September 5 – September 20
Season: 95–125 days

THIS MONTH — MAY 2026

1. Start cucumbers, squash, melons & pumpkins indoors now (3–4 weeks before last frost). Zone 3's short season demands this head start.
2. Direct sow peas, spinach & radishes as soon as soil is workable — these tolerate frost and should go in even if snow is still possible.
3. Finish pepper & eggplant seedlings under lights — started in Feb, they need 4–6 more weeks before outdoor temps allow transplanting.

QUICK-START CROPS

Bush beans (Provider OP)
Direct sow after last frost. 55-day crop, reliable in short seasons.

Kale (Lacinato H)
Cold-hardy; harvest June through first hard freeze. Frost improves flavor.

Stupice tomato (OP)
52–65 day short-season variety — the standard Zone 3 tomato.

STORAGE & PRESERVATION

- Batch-process at harvest peak. Lacto-ferment greens: no canning equipment needed, 20 min hands-on per batch.
- Root cellar (cool basement corner, 35–40°F) extends beets, carrots & potatoes into spring.
- Freeze or dehydrate beans in July when Zone 3 bush beans all ripen within two weeks.

ZONE
3

Northern Plains, Mountain Interior, Upper Great Lakes
International Falls MN · Bismarck ND

HEIRLOOM VARIETY SPOTLIGHT

Stupice tomato (H)
Czech heirloom, 52–65 days. Small red fruits, reliable in Zone 3. Save seed year after year.

Waltham 29 broccoli (H)
74-day compact heads, handles Zone 3 cold. Plant in March for June harvest.

Golden Bantam sweet corn (H)
75 days, historic American heirloom. Grows in Zone 3's warmest microsites. Direct sow after last frost.